

Kelpwright Instruments

Employee Handbook

Effective 2026-02-01.

This handbook is a synthetic document written to test a retrieval system. The company, the people, and every figure in it are invented.

1. Welcome

Kelpwright Instruments is a fictional company. It designs and manufactures instruments that measure water quality for utilities, port authorities and environmental agencies. The company is headquartered in Fairmont, Coastland, with a laboratory and a production line on the same site.

This handbook sets out the terms that apply to everyone employed by the company. Where a subject is governed by a separate policy, this handbook points to that policy rather than repeating it, so that there is one authoritative statement of each rule.

2. Working hours

The standard working week is 38 hours. Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00, Monday to Friday, and employees are expected to be contactable and available for meetings during that window.

Time worked outside core hours is flexible and is arranged with the line manager. Flexibility is a mutual arrangement: it is agreed in advance, it is recorded, and it does not change the total contracted hours.

2.1 Remote work

Employees may work remotely for up to 2 days per week. Remote working requires manager approval, and it is not available during the first 3 months of employment.

Remote days are agreed as a recurring pattern rather than requested individually, so that team coverage is predictable. Roles that require physical access to the laboratory, the production line, or a customer site are agreed case by case.

3. Leave

Employees receive 26 days of annual leave in each calendar year. One additional day is granted for every five completed years of service, up to a maximum of 30 days. The entitlement is stated in working days and excludes public holidays observed in Coastland, which are additional and are published separately by People Operations at the start of each year.

Leave is booked through the people system and requires the agreement of the line manager before it is confirmed. Managers are asked to respond to a request within five working days. Where a request cannot be accommodated, the manager states the operating reason and works with the employee to find alternative dates. Requests are considered in the order they are received, and no employee has a standing claim on a particular week.

Employees joining partway through a calendar year receive a proportion of the annual entitlement calculated on completed months of service, rounded up to the nearest half day. The same proportional calculation applies to employees leaving partway through a year, and any balance is settled in the final salary payment. Employees working a reduced week receive the entitlement pro rata to their contracted hours, calculated on the same basis and recorded against their contract rather than against the standard week.

Field service teams coordinate leave within their own team calendar so that at least one engineer qualified on each instrument family remains available. Laboratory and production teams follow the same principle. Where two requests conflict and no alternative can be found, the manager escalates to People Operations rather than deciding on length of service alone.

Leave taken must be recorded in the people system even where it has been agreed verbally. An unrecorded absence cannot be reconciled at year end, and the reconciliation is what produces the

balance an employee sees. Employees are asked to check their recorded balance at the end of each quarter and to raise a correction promptly rather than at year end, when the correction window is short and the evidence is harder to reconstruct.

Where an employee falls ill during a period of booked annual leave, the days affected may be reclassified as sickness absence and returned to the annual leave balance, subject to the certification requirements set out in the next subsection. The reclassification is not automatic and must be requested within one month of returning to work.

Disagreements about a leave balance or a refused request are raised first with the line manager and then, if unresolved, with People Operations. People Operations holds the authoritative record and its reconciliation is final for the purposes of payroll.

The company does not operate an unlimited or discretionary leave arrangement, and no manager may agree an entitlement that differs from the figures stated in this section. Any local arrangement that appears to do so has been misunderstood and should be referred to People Operations.

Up to 5 unused days may be carried into the next year, and days carried over in this way must be used by 31 March.

3.1 Sickness

Absence through illness may be self-certified for up to 3 consecutive days. A medical certificate is required from day 4 of a continuous absence.

Notify the line manager as early as possible on the first day of absence, and keep them informed while the absence continues.

4. Probation and notice

Probation is 6 months from the start date. During probation the notice period is 2 weeks on either side. Once probation has been completed, the notice period is 8 weeks on either side.

A probation period may be extended once, by agreement, where an employee has had a significant absence during it. An extension is confirmed in writing before the original period ends.

5. Equipment

Laptops are refreshed every 4 years. A replacement outside that cycle requires a documented fault or a documented change in role requirements.

Instruments loaned for field work are booked through the service desk. Loaned instruments are returned to the service desk for calibration checks before they are issued again.

6. Expenses

Travel and subsistence are governed by the Travel and Expenses Policy. Rates, approval thresholds and claim deadlines are stated there and are not repeated in this handbook.

7. Contacts

People Operations: people-ops@kelpwright.example

IT service desk: extension 4120

Enquiries that do not fit either route go to People Operations, who will direct them. Individual contact

details are held in the people system and are not published in this handbook.

Notes

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